

Empower Lab — What We Need, and What It Costs

Budget request · 400 students · one academic year · figures in US dollars (USD) and Turkish lira (TL)

The good news first: the app is already built and working (7 skills, live classroom games, assignments, a teacher dashboard). We are **not** paying to build a website — a school would normally pay **\$500–\$2,000+** (about **23,000–92,000 TL**) for that. We only need to *run* it, which is inexpensive. Three small things:

1. Two web addresses (domains)

One for the app, one for the FSM hub. The university already owns **fsm.edu.tr**, so our IT team can give us two **free** addresses such as **empowerlab.fsm.edu.tr** and **hub.fsm.edu.tr**.

Cost: \$0 (0 TL). (A brand-new address, if ever wanted, is about \$12–15 per year — roughly 550–700 TL.)

2. A Google “Blaze” account for the app

The app is on Google’s **free** plan, which has a daily usage limit. When all 400 students log in at peak times it hits that limit and the app **stops working**. The **Blaze** (pay-as-you-go) plan removes the limit — it keeps the same free allowance and only charges for the small amount used beyond it.

Cost: about \$5–8 per month (about **230–370 TL**) for all 400 students — often less. We set a **\$25/month (about 1,150 TL) ceiling** so the bill can never exceed expectations.

3. Optional Google services (“APIs”)

Service	What it adds	Monthly cost
Voice audio (Text-to-Speech)	Reads lesson text aloud in a natural voice (e.g. a vocabulary word or a listening passage). Created automatically and saved — you don’t record anything.	about free ~ 0 TL
AI helper (Gemini Haiku or Claude)	Draft writing feedback, grammar checks, auto-create practice questions, a tutor chatbot.	Gemini \$1–10 (~ 50–460 TL) Claude \$3–20 (~ 140–920 TL)
Speaking practice (Speech-to-Text)	Listen to a student speak and score pronunciation.	\$50–95 ~ 2,300–4,400 TL or \$0 with the free browser version to start

*Note: the in-app AI that serves students runs on **Gemini** (cheapest, built straight into Firebase). The **Claude Max** subscription in the total below is a separate developer tool — the account we use to build, fix and author content for the app.*

Total budget (recommended path + Claude Max)

Item	Per month	Per year
Web addresses (fsm.edu.tr subdomains)	\$0 0 TL	\$0 0 TL
Firebase Blaze (hosting + database)	\$5–8 ~ 230–370 TL	\$60–100 ~ 2,750–4,600 TL
In-app AI + voice for students (Gemini)	\$1–10 ~ 50–460 TL	\$12–120 ~ 550–5,500 TL
Claude Max — build & maintain the app	\$100 ~ 4,600 TL	\$1,200 ~ 55,000 TL
TOTAL	~\$106–118 ~ 4,900–5,400 TL	~\$1,300–1,400 ~ 60,000–65,000 TL

What to approve: (1) two free **fsm.edu.tr** web addresses; (2) a **Firebase Blaze** account (capped \$25/month); and (3) a **Claude Max** subscription at **\$100/month** to build & maintain the app. **Grand total ~\$106–118/month (~4,900–5,400 TL)**, about **\$1,300–1,400/year (~60,000–65,000 TL)** — of which \$100/month is Claude Max; the app’s own running cost is only ~\$6–18/month.

Optional premium speaking scoring (Speech-to-Text) would add ~\$50–95/month (~2,300–4,400 TL) if enabled — free via the browser to start, so it is not in the total. Claude Max is a fixed monthly subscription (not metered). Prices are public list prices (USD); TL uses about 46 TL per US\$1 (June 2026) and moves with the exchange rate. Actual cost scales with real usage and is usually lower.